Performance Review Guide for Managers

Managers only | Effective 1 January 2026 | Owner: Human Resources

1. Review Cycle

The annual performance review takes place in April and covers the previous financial year. A mid-year check-in is held in October. Ratings are final only after calibration.

2. Rating Scale

Rating	Label	Description
5	Outstanding	Consistently far exceeds goals and raises the bar for the team.
4	Exceeds expectations	Regularly exceeds goals in most areas.
3	Meets expectations	Fully meets goals; solid and reliable performance.
2	Partially meets expectations	Meets some goals; clear improvement is needed.
1	Does not meet expectations	Does not meet most goals; requires a performance improvement plan.

3. Rating Distribution Guideline

To keep ratings consistent across teams, each department should broadly follow this distribution: up to 10% at rating 5, about 25% at rating 4, about 50% at rating 3, about 10% at rating 2 and up to 5% at rating 1. The distribution is a guideline, not a forced quota.

4. Calibration

Before ratings are shared with employees, managers in each department meet with the HR business partner to compare proposed ratings, check that the same standard has been applied across teams, and agree final ratings. Managers must bring written evidence for every rating of 5, 2 or 1.

5. Performance Improvement Plans

An employee rated 1 is placed on a 60-day performance improvement plan with documented, measurable goals. The HR business partner must be involved from the start, and the manager holds a check-in with the employee every two weeks.

6. Writing the Review

Write about outcomes and behaviours, not personality. Use specific examples from the whole year, not only recent weeks, and agree two or three development goals for the coming year.